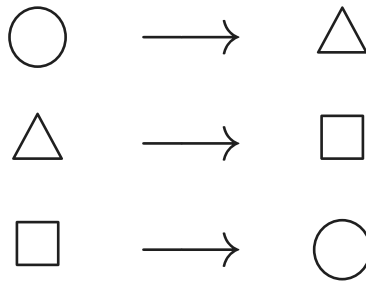


The changing-symbol machine

Name: _____

Date: _____

One turn changes each symbol by the same key. Point, draw, or use symbol cards. Try making messages before using the key.



1. Send it through.

What comes out of this message? Read one symbol at a time.



My new message (draw or place cards):

2. Run it backward.

Your friend receives □. What went in? Can you point backward along an arrow to check? Try each symbol.

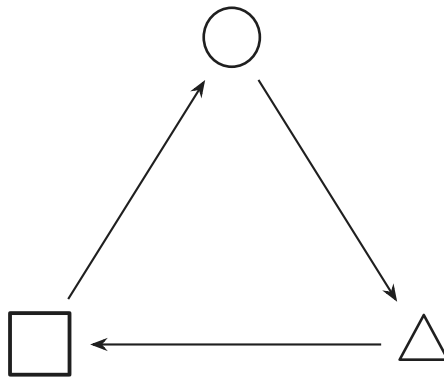
Make a message for someone else to decode.

Try it with objects. Explain by pointing, talking, or drawing.

When does it come home?

3. Keep going!

Put a counter on the circle. Follow one arrow each turn. How many turns before it first comes back? Try starting at a different symbol.



4. Change the key.

Now circle becomes triangle, triangle becomes circle, and square stays square. Will all symbols come home together after two turns? Show it with three counters.

Adult: record the child's experiment or explanation.

Try a broken key: If circle and triangle both become square, can a receiver know which one you sent?

Try it with objects. Explain by pointing, talking, or drawing.